



Reigniting Resilience

Combating Leader & Team Burnout

Sierra Ramm Cantrell | Chief Joy Officer & Mindfulness Sherpa

Welcome to your Burnout Resource Toolbox. This guide is designed to help you recognize the stages and symptoms of burnout, understand what you can and cannot control, and take practical steps to reignite your resilience — starting today.

1 The Burnout Crisis: Why It Matters

86%

of US employees report issues of burnout
(Forbes, 2024)

85%

of bosses recognize burnout is a crisis
(Barrons)

12B

estimated working days lost per year
(WHO)

\$2T

estimated cost of burnout per year
(Business Insider)

2 The 5 Stages of Burnout

1 Honeymoon Phase

High energy, enthusiasm, and commitment. You take on tasks readily and feel optimistic about your work.

2 Onset of Stress

You begin to notice the strain. Some days are harder than others, and initial optimism starts to wane.

3 Chronic Stress

Stress becomes persistent. Exhaustion is frequent and you may start to dread work or specific tasks.

4 True Burnout

Full burnout state. Symptoms become critical, significantly impacting your daily life and functioning.

5 Habitual Burnout

Burnout becomes the norm. Symptoms are so deeply embedded in your life they feel like permanent fixtures.

3 Recognizing the Symptoms

PERSONAL & PHYSICAL

- › Headaches & physical tension
- › Chronic fatigue & exhaustion
- › Cynicism & negative outlook
- › Impatience & irritability
- › Detachment from work & relationships
- › Gastrointestinal distress

ORGANIZATIONAL & TEAM

- › Decreased productivity & missed deadlines
- › Increase in errors & mistakes
- › Excessive sick days & absenteeism
- › Company or job resentment
- › Increased turnover & attrition
- › Decreased collaboration & poor culture



4 The Dichotomy of Control

A core Stoic principle for building resilience is focusing your energy **only on what you can control** and releasing what you cannot. When you clearly differentiate your inner circle from the outer ring of external factors, you conserve vital energy and reduce the overwhelm that accelerates burnout.

✓ YOUR INNER CIRCLE — WHAT YOU CAN CONTROL

- ✓ Your Thoughts
- ✓ Your Beliefs
- ✓ Your Emotions
- ✓ Your Actions
- ✓ Your Decisions
- ✓ Your Character

✗ THE OUTER RING — WHAT YOU CANNOT CONTROL

- ✗ Others' Thoughts, Beliefs & Emotions
- ✗ Others' Actions & Decisions
- ✗ Circumstances & Outcomes
- ✗ Market Demands & Project Pivots
- ✗ The Weather
- ✗ External Events

"Make the best use of what is in your power, and take the rest as it happens."

— Epictetus | Stoic Philosopher



Section 5: Your Action Steps — Let's Light a Fire

Instead of rubbing sticks together and hoping for a spark, use the right tools to reignite your resilience efficiently. Work smarter, not harder.

★ What's Today's Burn Risk? — Daily Self-Check

● Green

Energized & engaged. Maintain habits and protect recovery time.

● Yellow

Feeling the strain. Release one Outer Ring stressor today.

● Orange

Warning zone. Reduce commitments, prioritize sleep, seek support.

● Red

Danger zone. Stop and seek help. Act now, not later.

→ Practical Actions to Take Right Now

- 1 Name Your Stage.** Be honest about which of the 5 stages you are currently experiencing. Awareness is the first act of resilience.
- 2 Audit Your Stressors.** List your current stressors. Cross off everything in the Outer Ring — things you cannot control. Redirect your energy to your Inner Circle.
- 3 Monitor Your Symptoms.** Don't ignore the physical and emotional warning signs your body is sending. They are data, not weakness.
- 4 Check Your Burn Risk Daily.** Make the self-assessment gauge a morning ritual. A 30-second check-in can prevent a 3-month recovery.
- 5 Access Your Free Resources.** Visit the Burnout Resource Page for tools, practices, and ongoing support to sustain your resilience.

Connect With Sierra

Chief Joy Officer & Mindfulness Sherpa | Painted Porch Strategies

mindfulnesssherpa.com radicallymindful.com

"Everything is figure-outable."

— Sierra Ramm Cantrell